

Majid Mumtaz

Strategic Audit & Governance Advisory

CIA, ACA, FCCA | Dubai, UAE (Deployable Globally)

majidrajpar@gmail.com | Portfolio & Methodologies

Board-facing assurance for complex, multi-brand operating environments.

Standard audit sampling leaves capital exposed. I provide strategic internal audit, fraud forensics, and governance transformation for family offices, holding groups, and pre-IPO environments. By shifting from traditional sampling to data-driven population testing, I uncover the operational and governance gaps that standard compliance exercises miss. Over the last 20+ years, I have delivered 17 high-stakes strategic projects, securing millions in at-risk capital.

Core Advisory Mandates

1. Fraud & Forensic Diagnostics

For when you suspect leakage but standard audits return clean.

- **Methodology:** Complete population data extraction and algorithmic anomaly detection to identify control circumventions and supplier collusion.
- **Outcome:** Rapid identification of revenue leakage and actionable recovery pathways.
- **Proof Point:** Recovered AED 7.7M in a single engagement from the 95% of transactions standard sampling would have missed.

2. Audit & Governance Transformation

For when your internal audit acts as a compliance checkbox rather than a strategic asset.

- **Methodology:** Restructuring audit programs to align directly with board-level commercial risks and operational realities.
- **Outcome:** A lean, high-velocity audit function that operators trust and the Board relies on.
- **Proof Point:** Reduced fraud incidents by 78% during a period of 340% transaction volume surge at a major GCC holding group.

3. Pre-IPO & M&A Diligence Readiness

For when preparing for capital markets or acquiring complex targets.

- **Methodology:** Stress-testing IT General Controls (ITGC) and governance frameworks against stringent regulatory standards (e.g., Tadawul Nomu).
- **Outcome:** Bulletproof governance narratives that withstand underwriter and regulatory scrutiny.
- **Proof Point:** Uncovered SAR 15M in hidden exposures during buy-side due diligence, shifting negotiation leverage entirely.

4. Enterprise Risk & IT Governance

For when boards need quantifiable assurance over cyber exposures and corporate risk.

- **Methodology:** Board-commissioned ERM framework design and cybersecurity vendor governance (e.g., MSSP selection and oversight).
- **Outcome:** Quantifiable risk reduction, structured threat monitoring, and tangible cost savings.
- **Proof Point:** Built an ERM framework that directly informed a corporate insurance strategy overhaul, reducing Group premiums by 15%.

The Operating Thesis

Business Problem First. Controls Second.

A control that stops the business from operating is a failed control. I do not sell "best practice" compliance binders that gather dust. I build and audit controls that reflect commercial reality, utilizing automated data pipelines to monitor risk continuously without slowing down operations.

Authored Frameworks & Industry Recognition

Recognized voice in modern governance with five published texts, including *Handbook of Risk Red Flags in Restaurants* and *10 Forensic Accounting Skills*. Methodologies regularly featured in:

- **IIA Internal Auditor:** *Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags*
- **ACCA AB Magazine:** *Keeping Risk Registers Relevant*
- **Corporate Compliance Insights:** *FCPA Compliance Programs Are Missing Important Nuances*

Executive Testimonials

"Majid approaches complex matters with maturity and calm, and his recommendations are always grounded in a deep understanding of both risk and business impact. Any organisation—particularly within the F&B or consumer space—would benefit greatly from his leadership."

— **Sally Swanepoel, Founder (Former Colleague at Kitopi)**

"His ability to bridge the gap between complex risk environments and practical, actionable business solutions is unmatched. Majid is a rare breed of auditor who actually understands how a business breathes."

— **Steve Skoien, CEO**

Engagement Models

Available for deployment via **Catalant**, **Veritux**, or **Direct Independent Contract**.

- **Targeted Diagnostics:** 2–4 week intensive sprints to validate a specific risk or forensic suspicion.

- **Transformation Projects:** 3–6 month mandates to rebuild governance frameworks or prepare for IPO.
- **Fractional CAE Advisory:** Ongoing board-level assurance for family offices.